



# Ask ONE: AI self-service

A customer experience, a technical direction and a research plan

# A useful answer with a clear next action

## Ask ONE

Knowledge guidance

Where can I find shipping instructions guidance?

Here is the matching guide. Open it for the submission steps, then check your booking for shipment-specific details.

### EXAMPLE SOURCE

#### Shipping Instructions guide

Source title and relevant section accompany the answer.

Open guide

ONE eCommerce

## Less searching, clearer guidance

### Ground the answer

Use permitted documents and show where the guidance comes from.

### Keep the next step useful

Link to an existing service when the task needs shipment-specific information.

### Start with knowledge

Assess live lookups separately after confirming demand and API access.

# Ask Maersk provides a useful starting pattern

|                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>Knowledge answers</p> <p>Explain the topic</p> <p>Guidance with context</p> <p>Captured responses explain shipping topics and point to related content.</p> | <p>Service referral</p> <p>Move the task forward</p> <p>A useful handoff</p> <p>A schedule-related response directs the customer to official tools or local offices.</p> | <p>Research implication</p> <p>Test the ONE experience</p> <p>Use our own journeys</p> <p>Compare the proposed experience with search and existing help journeys.</p> |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

The recordings include incomplete turns. They establish observed patterns, not production reliability or ONE customer demand.

# GKE hosts Ask ONE. Vertex AI composes answers.

|                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>01</div> <div>Application</div> <div>Ask ONE on GKE</div> <div>Web experience and Node.js APIs handle requests, permissions and service links.</div> | <div>02</div> <div>Retrieval</div> <div>RAG over permitted sources</div> <div>Find relevant passages with source, version and audience metadata.</div> | <div>03</div> <div>Generation</div> <div>Gemini through Vertex AI</div> <div>Compose a response from the retrieved evidence, then check citations and policy.</div> |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                         |                                                                                       |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial storage options | Cloud Storage for source versions. Cloud SQL with pgvector for retrieval experiments. |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

For the example: locate the permitted guide, compose grounded guidance and return the source alongside the service link.

# A small, governed document set comes first

|                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>01</div> <div>Collect</div> <div>Start with CMS guides and a small set of permitted documents.</div> <div>Output</div> <div>Source inventory and owners</div> | <div>02</div> <div>Prepare</div> <div>Extract content, remove duplicates and retain source metadata.</div> <div>Output</div> <div>Versioned, searchable passages</div> | <div>03</div> <div>Evaluate</div> <div>Test retrieval and answers with reviewed customer questions.</div> <div>Output</div> <div>Quality evidence and content gaps</div> | <div>04</div> <div>Maintain</div> <div>Owners review releases, updates and removals.</div> <div>Output</div> <div>Current sources with rollback history</div> |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

For the example guide, retain its owner, audience, version and source link through every step.

# Knowledge owners can see what needs attention

| Knowledge & Quality Hub                                           |                 | Example review queue  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------|
| Item                                                              | State           | Next action           |
| Shipping Instructions guide                                       | Revision staged | Review source changes |
| Customer question set                                             | Check failed    | Inspect the answer    |
| Previous source version                                           | Retained        | Restore if needed     |
| Source history, review evidence and release actions in one place. |                 |                       |

## Human control stays visible

### Source ownership

Connect each document to an owner and permitted audience.

### Review before publication

Check evidence before publishing or replacing a source version.

### Improve deliberately

Turn feedback into reviewed changes and repeat the tests.

# Access rules stay in control of every answer

## Before retrieval

Authenticate where needed, validate inputs and enforce request limits.

## During retrieval

Filter sources by audience and version. Treat document text as untrusted input.

## Before response

Check source support, citations and output policy. Use a safe fallback on failure.

### ILLUSTRATIVE ACCESS TEST

## A public question meets a restricted document

### Expected behavior

Exclude the restricted passage before generation.

### Customer response

Use permitted guidance or refer to support when evidence is insufficient.

Model Armor is a screening option within the wider control chain.

# One reviewed case tests the answer from end to end

## SAME CUSTOMER QUESTION

### Shipping instructions guidance

#### Expected evidence

The current permitted guide and a valid source reference.

#### Expected behavior

Explain only what the guide supports and offer the relevant next action.

#### Failure case

An unsupported deadline, broken citation or restricted passage.

### Retrieval quality

Relevant passages, source coverage and correct audience filtering.

### Answer quality

Source support and relevance, using Ragas as an option.

### Human and security review

Correct guidance, useful handoff and protected information.

Compare with ordinary search. Define success criteria before running the experiment.

# Each request should explain its outcome and cost

| REQUEST             | RETRIEVAL          | MODEL CALL         | RESPONSE             |
|---------------------|--------------------|--------------------|----------------------|
| Audience and intent | Source and version | Latency and tokens | Citations and policy |

## Service health

Track completed responses, errors, availability and response time.

### Action

Route failures and unusual activity to the responsible team.

## Cost control

Measure usage across models, retrieval, screening and evaluation.

### Action

Use quotas, token caps and bounded retries to control spend.

## Continuous improvement

Link feedback to the source or processing step that needs attention.

### Action

Review the change, retest and compare the next version.

Keep traces useful with correlation IDs, redaction, access limits and retention rules.

# Discovery produces a scope we can test

01

## Research brief

Priority journeys, expected customer benefit and a comparison with existing tools.

02

## Knowledge sample

Permitted documents, owners, extraction findings and representative questions.

03

## Feasibility findings

GKE and Vertex AI access, retrieval options, safeguards and cost assumptions.

04

## Experiment scope

A bounded PoC outline with success criteria, dependencies and remaining risks.

Focused technical experiments support discovery. Production ingestion, Hub delivery and live integrations are later work.

# Four work packages lead to a team review

| Work package          | Contributors                                            | Visible output                           |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| 1. Frame the journey  | PPO / product with research / UX                        | Research brief and example experience    |
| 2. Assess the sources | Research and technical contributors with content owners | Permitted sample and source inventory    |
| 3. Test feasibility   | Technical contributors with platform and security input | Experiment findings and effort estimates |
| 4. Review together    | PPO, research and technical contributors                | Refined scope and the next experiment    |

Agree contributors and a working review date after sizing the first research tasks. No fixed duration is assumed.

# A small research package comes first

- 1 Choose a priority customer journey with PPO and research contributors.
- 2 Identify a permitted document sample and its content owners.
- 3 Prepare the example answer, evaluation cases and a bounded feasibility check.

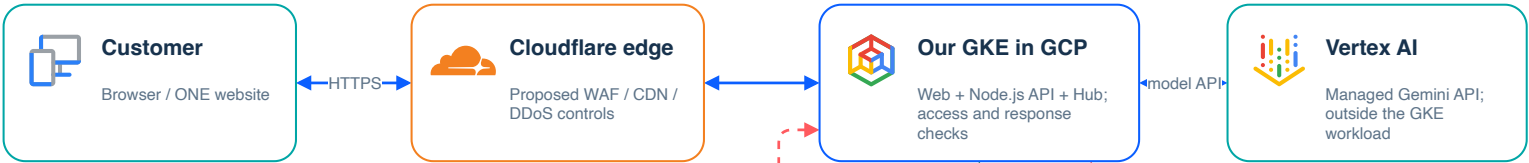
Bring a research brief and evidence to the first team review.

# Platform architecture

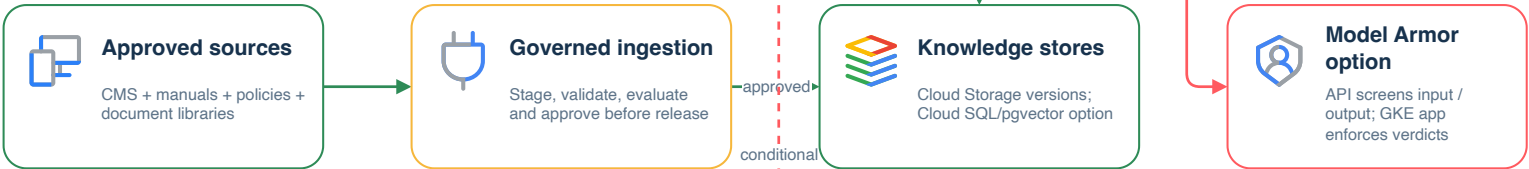
## Ask ONE on our GKE · managed AI through Vertex AI

Proposed delivery design · Phase 1 defines requirements, capacity, access and cost before any build decision

### CUSTOMER REQUEST / CHECKED RESPONSE



### GOVERNED KNOWLEDGE · PROPOSED STORAGE AND SCREENING OPTIONS



### CONDITIONAL LIVE LOOKUPS · OPERATING CONTROLS



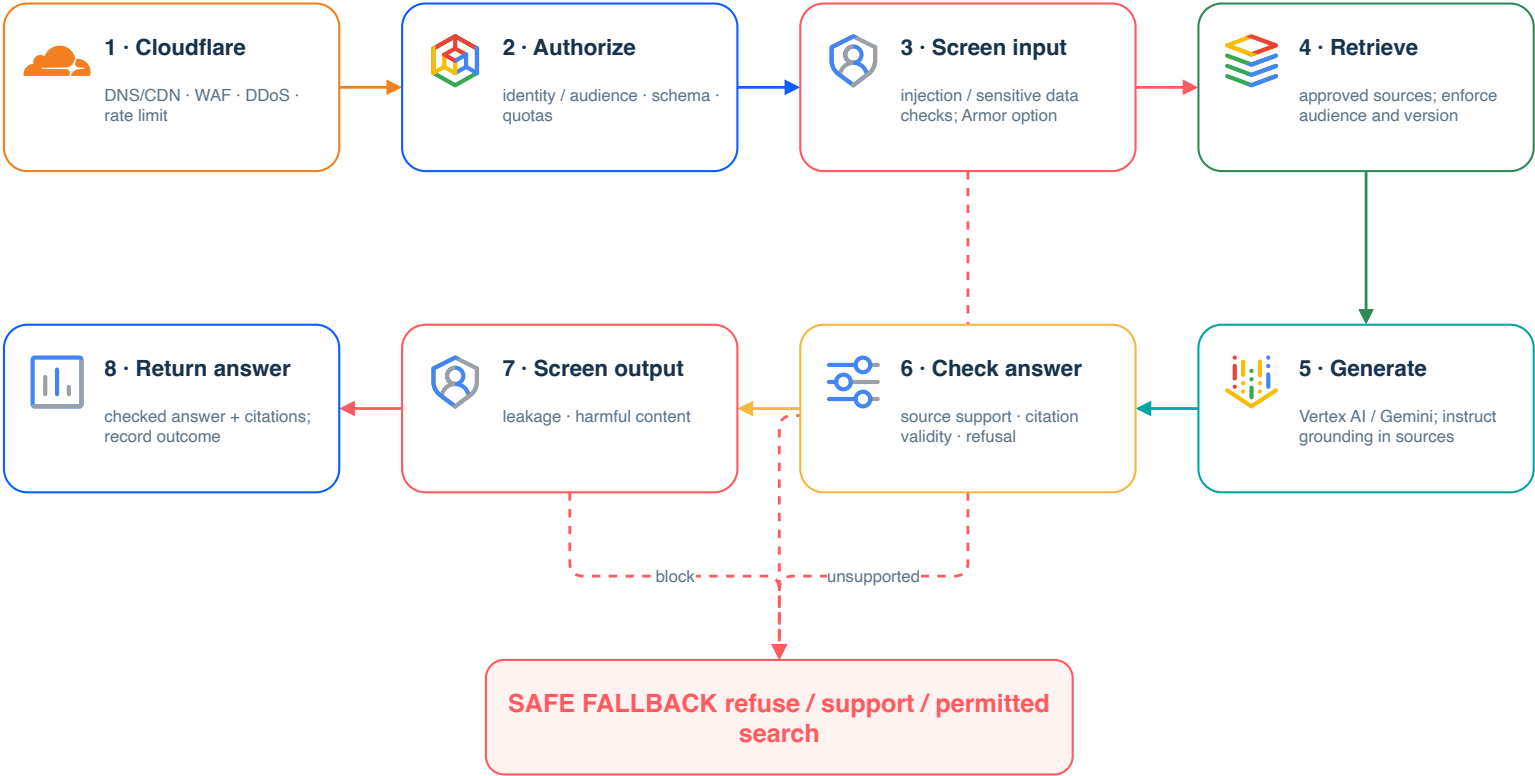
Observability correlates application, retrieval, model and security events across the service.

GKE hosts the application. Vertex AI supplies managed inference. Storage and screening components remain options.

# Security controls

## Proposed security flow · enforce controls in the application

Any failed policy check stops the answer; fallback preserves access restrictions. Monitoring covers every stage.



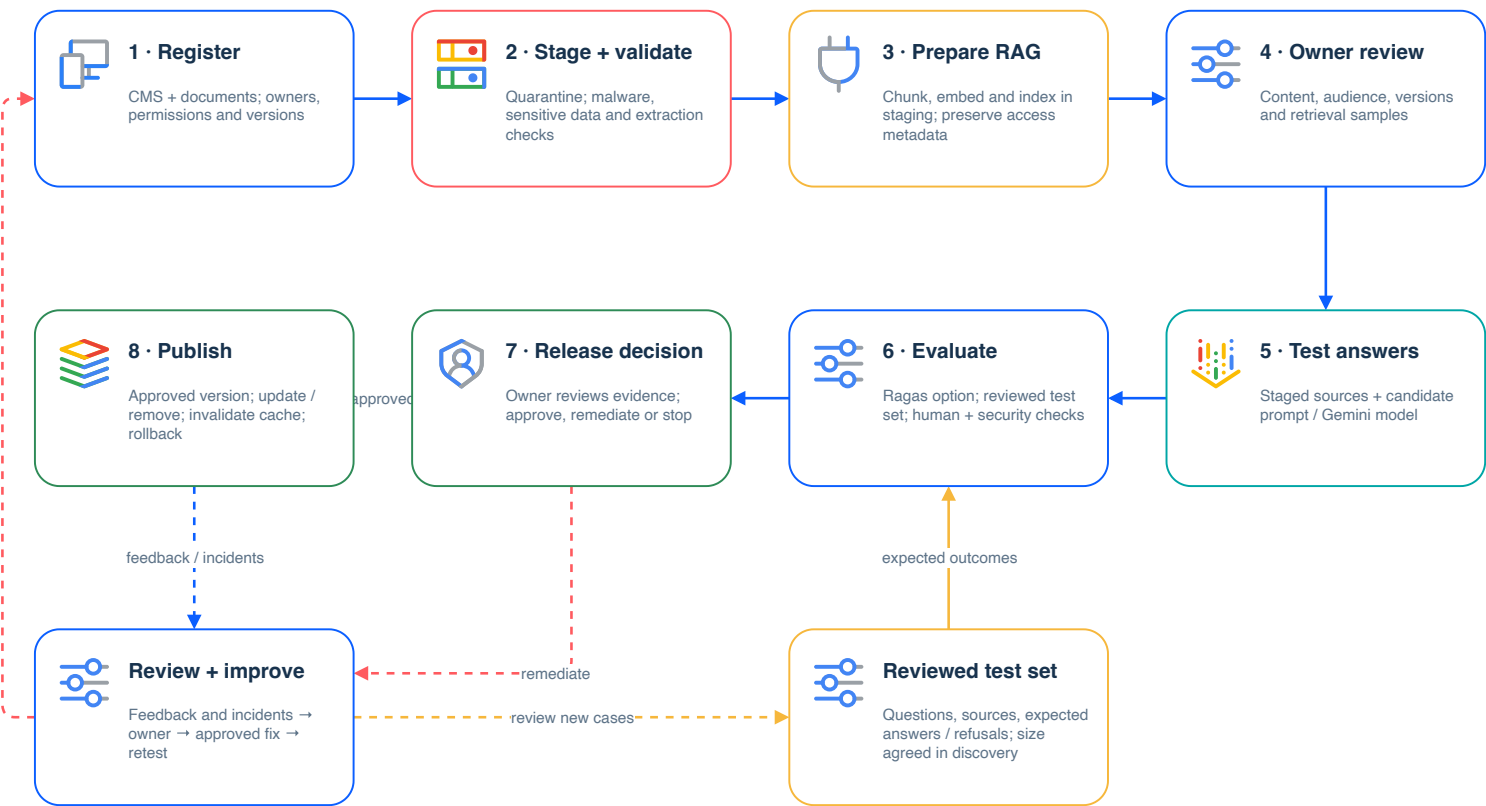
Across all stages: redacted traces, denied access, suspicious activity and alerts to incident owners.

Application controls enforce access. Screening complements authorization and safe fallback.

# Knowledge and quality workflow

## Proposed knowledge lifecycle · evaluate before publishing

Keep changes staged until quality, security and owner review approve release. Feedback returns through testing.



Later implementation concept · live operational data uses authorized APIs if justified; no fixed release sequence.

Source ownership, evaluation and review connect each release to its evidence.